WR227: Technical Writing

Nguyen V. Vu

Spring 2026

Teaching Staff

- Instructor
  - Nguyen V. Vu
    - FIT, HCMUS
    - Email: nvu@fit.hcmus.edu.vn
    - Phone: 090-817-5957
  - TA
    - TBA

Course Description

- Guide students methods and guidelines for writing technical documents, especially scientific papers, in computer science
- Provide opportunities for students to practice technical writing
- Prerequisites
  - None

Topics

- Topics covered
  - Common technical writing issues
  - Writing process, structure, and general guidelines
  - Writing scientific papers
    - Title and Abstract
    - Introduction
    - Background and related work
    - Method
    - Experiment
    - Results
    - Discussion
    - Threat to validity
    - Conclusion
- Text books
  - No required text book
  - Recommended: Justin Zobel, “Writing for Computer Science” (2nd Edition), Springer

Course objectives

- Upon the completion of this course, students will be able to
  - write scientific papers for computer science topics
  - understand different sections of a scientific papers
  - perform literature review for a paper
  - write introduction, background, related work, method, results, analysis and discussion, threats to validity, and conclusion of a paper
  - practice writing technical documents using formal English

Course Requirements

- Students are required to attend all classes
  - ≥70% class attendance is required for Paper and Presentation assignments
- Moodle used for material distribution and communication
- Questions beneficial to both the questioner and others should be posted on Moodle's forum
- Students encouraged to ask questions in class, via forum, email, or in-person
- Late submission policy
  - 15% grade reduction for each day late
  - Zero grade for 4 or more days late
  - Exceptions are given for certain cases, e.g., illness

Grading

- Grade Distribution
  - Individual Homework 15%
  - Discussion and Exercise 20%
  - Paper Presentation 10%
  - Paper 55%
- Grade in the 1000^{th} scale will be scaled into the 10^{th} scale

Paper

- Two students work together to write a scientific paper on a topic related to computer science
- The project is starting from the beginning till the end of the semester
- Follow process from writing, submission, review, rebuttal, revision, and resubmission

- All groups follow the same schedule

Academic Integrity

- Students are prohibited from copying
  - from classmates, friends even if allowed
  - from the Internet without proper citation (see below)
- Students are prohibited from allowing others to copy
- Other kinds of cheating and plagiarizing
- Some examples of plagiarism and cheating
  - copying someone else's work,
  - giving your work to others,
  - presenting someone else's ideas,
  - discussing with others during an exam,
  - copying text from sources without proper attribution,
  - using unauthorized materials

Academic Integrity (cont'd)

- How to cite sources properly?
  - If copying verbatim, put copied sentences/phrases in the double quotes
  - If rephrasing a source, put a reference to the source

- If the academic integrity violated, serious measures will be taken
  - 1st violation: zero grade for the assignment violating
  - 2nd violation and more: students will be failed the class and report to the school

Citation Examples

- Verbatim citation

  “It is a matter of some urgency that we as a research community define and agree reporting protocols and methods for comparison” [1]

- Rephrasing

  Shepperd believes that the research community needs to define a reporting protocols and methods for comparison [1]

- Reference

  [1] Shepperd M, "Software project economics: a roadmap", Future of Software Engineering (FOSE'07), 2007

Generative AI rules

- You are **not allowed** to use Generative AI (e.g., LLMs) to
  - generate content or revise content for papers
  - generate ideas, outlines
- You **are allowed** to Generative AI (e.g., LLMs) for analyzing papers, finding related work, manage papers/citations, annotate papers, etc.

Class Schedule

- See the schedule in Syllabus for detail

Questions?

Discussion

- Should students in this class use AI for generating content? Explain
- Find and present existing rules on the use of gen AI for conferences and journals